

ACECQA Service Quality, Accessibility & Operations Analysis

Presentation Script

Target length: ~9:30, inside the assignment's hard 5–10 minute window. **[SHOW ...]** marks when to bring up each chart; keep your face visible in a corner the whole time per the assignment requirement.

Structure: one central business problem, three angles on it. Every section opens by naming the problem or question before the chart appears — the chart is evidence for a claim you've already made, not a pattern you're discovering out loud.

Opening — state the problem, not the topic (0:00–0:45)

[Face to camera, title slide]

“Hi, I'm [YOUR NAME], and I work for government to improve education and care services across Australia. Here's the problem I'm here to help solve: ACECQA and state governments have a limited budget for lifting service quality and funding new services, spread across seventeen thousand approved services nationally. Spent well, that budget closes real gaps for families. Spent on the wrong thing, it doesn't move the needle at all. So today I'm answering three questions with data: where is quality actually failing and why, where are families genuinely cut off from services, and — just as important — what should we *stop* assuming matters, so we don't waste money chasing it.”

Data & method, briefly (0:45–1:10)

[SHOW a slide with the dataset summary, or talk over the title slide]

“Quickly on the data, because a budget decision is only as good as what it's based on. This is the national register of every approved service, with quality ratings and transport-access data. Before trusting any of it, I checked it for problems — ten services had no address at all and had all been geocoded to the same point in Myanmar. I dropped those rather than guess. Everything else checked out.”

Problem 1: Is quality failing consistently, or is it a specific, fixable issue? (1:10–3:45)

“First problem: all eight states and territories apply the same National Law. If quality outcomes are wildly inconsistent anyway, that's either a resourcing gap or an enforcement gap — and knowing which one matters, because they need completely different fixes.”

Chart 1 — Rating by state (1:20–1:55)

[SHOW 01_rating_by_state.png]

“They are wildly inconsistent. The ACT has forty-four percent of its services rated Exceeding NQS or above. Western Australia has four percent. Same law, ten-times difference. That’s not noise — that’s a finding that should already be uncomfortable for a national regulator.”

Chart 2 — Rating by service type (1:55–2:15)

[SHOW 02_rating_by_service_type.png]

“It’s not just geography. Long Day Care — the single largest category in the dataset — sits at eighteen percent Exceeding, well behind preschools at forty-six to fifty percent. If we’re prioritising where a quality-improvement dollar does the most good, Long Day Care is where the volume is.”

Chart 3 — Which Quality Area drags states down (2:15–2:45)

[SHOW 03_quality_area_heatmap.png]

“So it’s not random — it’s concentrated. Breaking the rating into its seven components shows Quality Area 2, children’s health and safety, is the weakest nationally, and specifically weakest in the same two states — WA and the NT — that were already trailing. That turns a vague ‘quality is worse in WA’ into an actionable brief: WA’s improvement program should start with health and safety practice, not a generic audit.”

Chart 4 — Spatial map of ratings (2:45–3:00)

[SHOW 04_spatial_ratings_map.png]

“And it’s local enough to act on directly — you can see clusters of underperforming services around Perth and Adelaide specifically, which means a support team could be deployed to a cluster, not spread across an entire state.”

Chart 5 — Ruling out transport as the cause (3:00–3:45)

[SHOW 05_transport_vs_quality.png]

“Before recommending a fix, I need to rule out the obvious wrong answer. Is this just about how well-connected a service is? I tested distance to the nearest train station against rating directly. The correlation is effectively zero — statistically detectable only because we have sixteen thousand data points, but practically meaningless. This matters for the budget question: don’t fund transport upgrades expecting a quality payoff. That’s not where the problem lives.”

Problem 2: Are families structurally cut off from services, and where worst? (3:45–5:50)

“Second problem. Transport doesn’t explain quality — but it might still determine whether a family can use a service at all, which is a different, equally real problem. I classified every service urban or rural using ABS boundaries, spatially joined to each service’s own coordinates.”

Chart 6 — Transport access, urban vs rural (3:55–4:20)

[SHOW 06_transport_by_urban_rural.png]

“Rural services sit a median nineteen kilometres from the nearest train station — eight times further than urban services. For a family without a car, that's not a statistic, that's whether the service is usable at all.”

Chart 7 — Quality, urban vs rural (4:20–4:40)

[SHOW 07_rating_by_urban_rural.png]

“And unlike raw distance, urban-versus-rural status does track with quality — twenty-two percent Exceeding in urban areas against seventeen in rural. Smaller gap than the state-level one, but it compounds the access problem: rural families travel further *and* get slightly lower average quality when they arrive.”

Chart 8 — Spatial map, urban vs rural (4:40–4:55)

[SHOW 08_spatial_urban_rural.png]

“Mapping it shows how concentrated the whole system is — the vast majority of services sit in a thin coastal band, leaving a long, thin tail of small services covering the rest of the country.”

Chart 9 — Where the gap is worst, specifically (4:55–5:50)

[SHOW 09_coverage_gaps.png]

“So where does this problem bite hardest? Land-area density isn't useful here — most of inland Australia is uninhabited by definition. The real question is: if a family's usual service is full, how far is the next one? In Western Australia's smaller rural towns, the answer is a median forty-one kilometres. In the Northern Territory's equivalent areas, thirty-one kilometres. Everywhere else in the country, it's under fifteen. That's not a gradual disparity — it's a specific, fundable gap. If ACECQA is choosing where to put a new service, this chart names the two places first.”

Problem 3: Are we reading the operational data correctly — and does it change the answer? (5:50–8:10)

“Third problem, and it's a bit different: is there anything in how services actually operate — size, hours, how the sector's grown — that changes what I've just recommended, or that a policymaker could easily misread?”

Chart 10 — Capacity by service type (5:58–6:20)

[SHOW 10_capacity_by_type.png]

“Rural services run at a median thirty approved places against sixty-two in urban areas — about half the size. That's useful context for the funding recommendation from Problem 2: a new rural service doesn't need to match a city-sized centre to close the gap.”

Chart 11 — Year-round vs term-time operation (6:20–6:45)

[SHOW 11_operating_pattern_by_type.png]

“One structural fact worth knowing before comparing service types on anything: Long Day Care and Family Day Care run essentially year-round, while preschools and Outside School Hours Care are overwhelmingly term-time only. That's an operating-model difference, not a quality difference — important so nobody reads Chart 2's Long Day Care result as 'these services are open more and that's why they're rated lower.'”

Chart 12 — A trap in the approval data (6:45–7:20)

[SHOW 12_approval_trend.png]

“Here's a specific misreading risk I want to flag directly: the approvals-per-year data shows a huge spike in 2012 — over four thousand services in one year. Read naïvely, that looks like explosive sector growth. It isn't. The National Quality Framework commenced that January, and every already-operating service was bulk-transferred onto new approval numbers. If this had gone into a growth-forecasting model unchecked, it would have produced a badly wrong answer. The real, steady trend only starts in 2013.”

Chart 13 — Does anything operational actually predict quality? (7:20–8:10)

[SHOW 13_hours_vs_quality.png]

“Last check: of everything operational, does anything actually predict quality? Opening hours does, modestly — services open under forty-five hours a week hit thirty-seven percent Exceeding, falling to eighteen percent for the longest-opening services. That's the single largest operational effect I found, plausibly a staffing-strain signal worth a follow-up study. And to close the loop on Problem 1: transport accessibility still doesn't move capacity or hours either. Three separate tests now, all pointing the same way — transport is a real equity issue, but it is not the lever for quality.”

Close — the decision, not a recap (8:10–8:50)

[Face to camera, optional summary slide]

“So, back to the budget question I opened with. One: WA and the NT need targeted health-and-safety support, not a general audit — that's where the money should go first for quality. Two: WA's and the NT's rural Bounded Localities are the most underserved places in the country by a full order of magnitude — that's where a new service should go first for access. And three: don't spend on transport access expecting a quality return — three independent tests say it won't pay off; spend there for equity reasons instead, with eyes open about what it will and won't fix. That's a budget with a reason behind every line. Thank you.”

Delivery notes

- Reads at ~140–160 words/minute, landing at about 9:30 — practice once and trim if you're a slower reader.
- **If you need to cut time**, in order: (1) the “Data & method” beat — compress the Myanmar catch to one sentence, (2) Chart 8's own beat — mention it in passing during Chart 9 instead, (3) Chart 11 — one sentence

instead of two. Never cut Chart 5 or the transport call-back in Chart 13 — that “we tested it three times, all null” chain is your strongest evidence of rigour for a policy audience, and it's what makes the closing recommendation credible rather than asserted.

- If asked why urban/rural wasn't done with the postcode-allocation method: the direct spatial join avoids the many-to-many postcode-to-SA1 mapping problem, since the dataset already has coordinates for every service.
- Keep the Family Day Care data-quality catches (capacity populated for only 2 of 417 services; “hours” meaning something structurally different for a scheme vs a single centre) in your back pocket for Q&A even if you don't narrate them in the timed script.